

Risk Signal & Readiness Gate

04

Reach never comes before readiness

This document supports disciplined, consistent decisions about when and how to communicate high-impact change. It is a decision-support tool, not an approval checklist.

Core principle

Reach never comes before readiness.

Why this matters

- Leaders should be prepared before Teams are exposed to new narratives.
- High-reach channels should be used intentionally and at the right moment.
- Communication sequencing should build confidence, not reaction.
- Internal alignment should precede external visibility.

When to apply this gate

- At the transition from planning into broad activation.
- Before using narrative-amplifying internal channels.
- Before enterprise-wide or external storytelling.
- When timing, channels, or sequencing are being pressure-tested for high-impact change.

Leader readiness and hydration risk assessment

Risk signal	Low risk	Medium risk	High risk
Leader enablement complete	Toolkits delivered; questions addressed.	Toolkits drafted but not socialized.	Leaders have not seen or been trained.
Leader confidence	Leaders can explain the change clearly.	Leaders are still asking foundational questions.	Leaders likely to learn at the same time as TMs.
Cascade clarity	Clear expectations for reinforcement.	Inconsistent understanding across levels.	No cascade plan.
Timing vs. exposure	Leaders equipped before any storytelling.	Storytelling planned close to enablement.	Storytelling precedes enablement.
Channel appropriateness	Channels match readiness.	Risk of premature narrative.	High-visibility channel before readiness.

Rule

If any dimension is High Risk, pause progression into Team Member-facing narrative or narrative-amplifying channels.

Channel risk classification

Channel type	Examples	Narrative risk	Guidance
Leader Enablement	Leader toolkits, leader FAQs, preview decks, office hours	Low	Safe for early use. Designed to build understanding and confidence before broader exposure.
Leader-Led Cascades	Manager emails, huddle talking points, team meeting scripts	Low-Medium	Appropriate once leaders are equipped. Reinforcement expected immediately after send.
Targeted TM Communication	Targeted role-specific emails, portal posts	Medium	Use after leader enablement. Ensure a clear escalation and clarification path exists.
Narrative-Amplifying Internal Channels	Broad storytelling, large-distribution newsletters, high-reach internal features	High	Use only after leader readiness is confirmed and narrative is stable. Not first exposure.
Enterprise-Wide Internal Channels	All-hands content, cross-org newsletters, enterprise storytelling	Very High	Requires confirmed leader confidence and internal stability.
External Communications	Press, employer branding, social, external storytelling	Critical	Only after internal adoption is stable, leaders report confidence, and early feedback indicates the change is working as intended.

GPT behavior

- Flag any requested high-reach channel before leader readiness.
- Recommend leader enablement before broad Team Member communication when risk is Medium or High.
- Recommend a pause when the narrative is unstable or leaders cannot explain the change.
- Treat external storytelling as the final step, not the first activation moment.

Source basis

This knowledge document was generated from the source materials listed below. It is intended to make the custom GPT's reference library cleaner and easier to follow; it is not a substitute for human review.

- Risk Signal.pdf
- Change Navigation Strategic Framework.